

STEP 2

DESCRIBING YOUR NETWORK

This portion of the assignment will guide you through the process of summarizing your social network's properties. You will measure properties of your ties (average tie strength, kinship, multiplexity, overall supportiveness), the composition of social network (age homophily, ethnic diversity, ethnic homophily), and the size and density of your network.

You will calculate each measure three times – once for Table 1, once for Table 2, and once for your entire network.

Table 1 Network

Start with the portion of your network that you described in Table 1 of the survey. These are the people with whom you discuss important matters, who provide material aid, and with whom are especially close. The table below will guide you through calculating some simple measures. List your answers rounded to 2 decimal places.

Measure	Survey Column to Use	Instructions	Your Work	Your Answer
Network Size	Names	Count the number of names listed in Table 1. Use this number as your “network size” for the rest of this table.		
Average Tie Strength	A	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by the network size listed above.		
Age Homophily	B	Count the number of people who are no more than 5 years older or 5 years younger than you. Divide by your network size.		
Proportion Female	C	Count the number of females. Divide by network size.		
Ethnic Diversity	D	Count the number of different ethnicities represented.		
Ethnic Homophily	E	Count the number of people who share your ethnicity. Divide by network size.		
Kin Centredness	F	Count the number of family members or relatives. Divide by your network size.		
Total Supportiveness	G	Check all boxes corresponding to types of support you receive. Count the number of boxes.	☐ Emotional aid ☐ Companionship ☐ Small services ☐ Large services ☐ Material aid ☐ School/Work support Number of boxes checked ____	
Average Multiplexity	H	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by your network size.		
Density	Entire table from question 8 on page 5	Count the number of Xs in the table. Divide by the number in the ‘Ignore’ column next to your network size.		

Table 2 Network

Start with the portion of your network that you described in Table 2 of the survey. These are your casual acquaintances, and the people who provide small services and companionship. The table below will guide you through calculating some simple measures. List your answers rounded to 2 decimal places.

Measure	Survey Column to Use	Instructions	Your Work	Your Answer
Network Size	Names	Count the number of names listed in Table 2. Use this number as your “network size” for the rest of this table.		
Average Tie Strength	A	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by the network size listed above.		
Age Homophily	B	Count the number of people who are no more than 5 years older or 5 years younger than you. Divide by your network size.		
Proportion Female	C	Count the number of females. Divide by network size.		
Ethnic Diversity	D	Count the number of different ethnicities represented.		
Ethnic Homophily	E	Count the number of people who share your ethnicity. Divide by network size.		
Kin Centredness	F	Count the number of family members or relatives. Divide by your network size.		
Total Supportiveness	G	Check all boxes corresponding to types of support you receive. Count the number of boxes.	☐ Emotional aid ☐ Companionship ☐ Small services ☐ Large services ☐ Material aid ☐ School/Work support Number of boxes checked ____	
Average Multiplexity	H	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by your network size.		
Density	Entire table from question 8 on page 5	Count the number of Xs in the table. Divide by the number in the ‘Ignore’ column next to your network size.		

Entire Support Network

To calculate measures based on your entire network, you will use both Table 1 and Table 2. **Before you start**, check the two tables to find out if there is anyone who you listed in both tables. If there is use a highlighter or pencil to draw a line through the row for those people in Table 1 (i.e. do something all the way across the row so you can still read what's written, but so you'll know not to use that row.) Now use both tables, but not the crossed out rows, to calculate the measures below.

Measure	Column to Use	Instructions	Your Work	Your Answer
Network Size	Names	Count the number of names listed. Use this number as your "network size" for the rest of this table.		
Average Tie Strength	A	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by the network size listed above.		
Age Homophily	B	Count the number of people who are no more than 5 years older or 5 years younger than you. Divide by your network size.		
Proportion Female	C	Count the number of females. Divide by network size.		
Ethnic Diversity	D	Count the number of different ethnicities represented.		
Ethnic Homophily	E	Count the number of people who share your ethnicity. Divide by network size.		
Kin Centredness	F	Count the number of family members or relatives. Divide by your network size.		
Total Supportiveness	G	Check all boxes corresponding to types of support you receive. Count the number of boxes.	☐ Emotional aid ☐ Companionship ☐ Small services ☐ Large services ☐ Material aid ☐ School/Work support Number of boxes checked ____	
Average Multiplexity	H	Add the numbers in this column. Divide the total by your network size.		
Density	No density calculation for the entire network.			